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In-person assistance for digital services

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE Cabinet has directed federal government entities to deploy trained staff at customer service centres nationwide to assist customers with completing digital transactions.

According to a Cabinet circular, all federal service centres must continue to welcome visitors in person and provide support, even as digital channels expand.

The directive places special emphasis on serving senior citizens and other groups with specific needs, ensuring that services are accessible, flexible, and user-friendly. By combining personal support with advanced technology, the initiative aims to provide a seamless and integrated customer experience.

The move comes in response to appeals from senior citizens, who have called for simplifying smart applications and making them more user-friendly. Earlier, many elderly users voiced concerns over complex interfaces, limited digital literacy, lack of trust in new technologies, and fears of privacy breaches.

Horror unfolds in Gaza City as Israeli strikes force exodus

CROWDS SEEN HEADING SOUTH ON FOOT, IN VEHICLES AND DONKEY CARTS

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Israeli tanks and warplanes pounded Gaza City yesterday, sending thousands of terrified civilians fleeing the territory's largest urban hub.

Thick plumes of smoke rose as AFP journalists saw crowds heading south on foot, in vehicles and donkey carts, their belongings piled high.

"There is artillery fire, air strikes, quadcopter and drone gunfire. The bombing never stops," said Aya Ahmed, 32, sheltering with 13 relatives. "They want us to evacuate south — but where will we live? There are no tents, no transport, no money."

Soaring cost of escape

The cost of escape has soared, with rides south sometimes topping \$1,000. Shadi Jawad, 47, said his family fled amid chaos: "The situation is indescribable — women and men crying and screaming. At one point I looked up and prayed, 'God, send a missile to take us out and relieve us.'"

The assault has triggered global alarm, with the UN de-



AFP

■ Displaced Palestinians move with their belongings southward on a road in the Nuseirat refugee camp area in the central Gaza Strip following renewed Israeli evacuation orders yesterday.

A new AP-NORC poll shows American attitudes shifting: about half of US adults now believe Israel's response has 'gone too far', up from 40 per cent last year.

claring famine in Gaza City and aid groups warning of catastrophic conditions. Nearly 90 per cent of Gaza's population has been displaced and more

than 65,000 killed, according to local health officials.

A new AP-NORC poll shows American attitudes shifting: about half of US adults now

believe Israel's response has "gone too far," up from 40 per cent last year. Seven in 10 Democrats and nearly half of independents agree, while Republicans remain less critical.

Israel faces mounting international scrutiny, with a UN inquiry concluding this week that its actions in Gaza amount to genocide.

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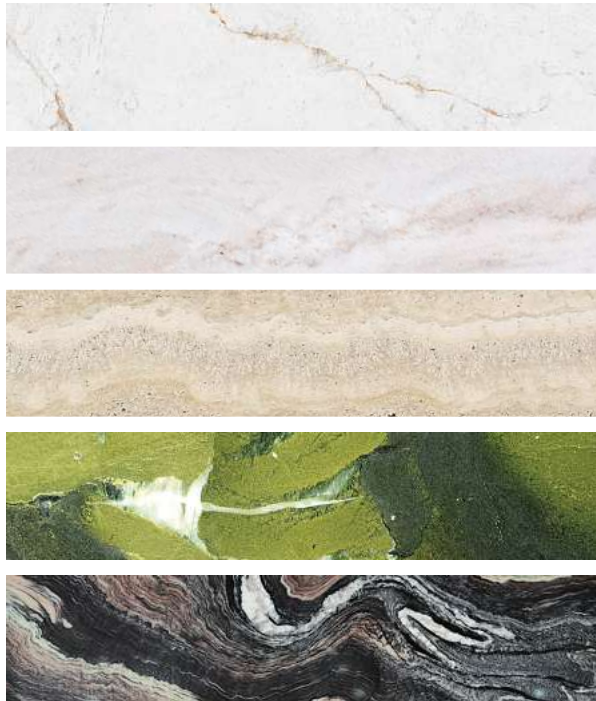
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